

TRAIL **AFRICA**

— FROM INFORMATION TO ACTION

A fact should **lead somewhere.**

A civic-information workspace for African communities. Find a fact, trace its source, connect it to the office that holds the next step — and leave with a packet you can send, print, or carry on a USB stick.

THE PROBLEM

Information without action **is just noise.**

- Fragmented across offices, formats and languages
- Out of date, with no way to tell from what's current
- Hard to verify — source, date and limits all unstated
- Locked behind systems that are hard to navigate

13

COUNTRIES

14

SEEDED TRAILS

4

DATA LAYERS

14K

BUNDLED POINTS

This is not a news feed.
It is a workspace.

1. Find a fact

Browse by track, country or layer. Every record names its source, when it was last checked, and what it does not tell you.

2. Follow the trail

Each record names a holder, a witness and the exact question to ask. A next step, not just a fact.

3. Leave with a packet

Send, print, broadcast or carry. Four formats for four real channels. The packet is the product.

Every record belongs to one.

Transparency & Accountability

Turn a published budget, tender, audit finding or service standard into a written question with a named recipient and a response date.

Stability & Social Cohesion

Route everyday friction — a broken water point, a land question, a shared-resource dispute — to the body that can resolve it, before it escalates.

Safety, Reporting & Protection

Write a report that carries no identifiers, get a reference, and reach a real pathway: oversight body, legal aid, or survivor support.

14 seeded records, 13 countries.

Each record carries:

- Source name, type, URL, update cadence
- Last-checked date (not assumed current)
- Explicit limitations (required field)
- Separate confidence & importance scores
- Named holder + witness
- The exact question to ask

EXAMPLE: MAKUENI, KENYA

Holder: County water services office

Witness: Community water committee

Ask: "Who is responsible for this water point, and when can the community expect a maintenance update?"

Source: Makueni County Government · checked 19 Sept · Unverified — illustrative

Residents raise what's not working.

Borehole at Kathiani market has been dry three weeks

Kathiani, Kenya · 7 votes · **Community-verified**

Tender award for the feeder road not published

Kumasi, Ghana · 4 votes · **Open**

GRADUATION

- ① Resident raises an issue with no votes
- ② At 3 votes → community-verified
- ③ At 5 votes → promoted to official trail with holder + date

Votes are local. Without a relay, nobody else sees them. Every issue card says so.

4 bundled layers, 14,288 points.

Every data-layer point is listed in the Trails tab and trackable as a trail.

LAYER	SOURCE	LICENCE	POINTS	STATUS
Health facilities	HOT OSM via HDX	ODbL 1.0	8,000	Bundled
Schools	HOT OSM via HDX	ODbL 1.0	4,000	Bundled
Power plants	WRI Global Power DB	CC BY 4.0	228	Bundled
Market centres	Ethiopia markets, HDX	CC0 1.0	2,060	Bundled

Everything else is scaffolding for **the thing the user leaves with.**

Packet · PDF

The full brief with a next-step sequence and acknowledgement lines. Exports as PDF, offline.

WhatsApp

Short, forwardable, keeps the source and the check date.

SMS

One line for a basic phone. Source + question intact.

Radio / Meeting

A script to read out, with a warning not to name individuals. For community meetings, radio call-ins, and print-and-carry.

It runs from a USB stick.

No server, no install, no network.

Two builds, genuinely different

Single-file (0.66 MB)

Double-click trail-offline.html. Boots because nothing is requested at runtime.

Folder (served)

Adds facility layers plus service-worker offline cache. Served only.

VERIFIED, NOT ASSUMED

- Offline cold-start over file://
- Persistent local storage
- Render correctness (markers, labels, icons)
- Layer toggle → marker count
- All tabs functional
- No console errors

Solo-built, **each tool doing what it's best at.**



Runtime: fixed human-curated data · zero generative features · safety wording written by hand

Every stage human-directed and verified — builds, logic tests, and a 30+ harness verification suite.

React 19, Vite, no backend.

Stack

- React 19 + Vite
- D3-geo (orthographic + Mercator)
- SVG markers with icon symbols
- Lucide icons
- Local storage (no backend)
- Service worker (offline cache)

Build pipeline

- Python ingest → GeoJSON simplification
- Vite build → dist/
- Portable bundler → single-file HTML
- Service worker generator
- Playwright verification (30+ harnesses)

Stated so nobody has to discover it.

No server

Votes and issues cannot sync between devices.

No live data

Snapshot dated 21 Sep 2026. Nothing polls.

No encryption

Local storage is readable by anyone with device access.

No referral DB

Report routes by category, not to a verified org list.

Share buttons

Need a connection (hand text to an app).

Anonymity

No state-run mechanism confirmed to accept anonymous submissions.

TRAIL **AFRICA**

A fact should lead somewhere.

Trusted civic information, across Africa.

13 countries. 14 trails. 4 data layers. 14K points. Zero server. Runs from a USB stick.
Leaves with a packet you can send.

github.com/Prodigeezyxx/trail · OSF × Andela · Sep 2026